

“It’s hard to focus on a sense of belonging in a beginners class. While this class is considered creative...its undeniable that the creativity in the course can only go so far when students still need to learn the not-so-creative basics of coding. If the course were maybe a 200 level course it would be easier to diversify the assignments and allow for more creativity and as a result, more diversity. For example, students would have the bandwidth to learn more things to put into their projects. This allows for more diverse projects for more diverse crowds. Like period trackers, makeup simulators, diverse cooking libraries, building programs like procreate or microsoft paint, etc. In terms of actually getting wider student bases into the classroom, I don’t think there’s any use in making students do something they are not interested in. Maybe tabling or presentations explaining the versatility of coding could help students understand all the possibilities that are out there in terms of coding...but ultimately, if students aren’t interested in coding--then thats it! Forcing students into something they have no interest in will only make a more potent negative impression. That’s all it really comes down to. Boys play with trucks and planes and girls play with barbies and easy bake ovens. While that is absolutely not the case for everyone, it is the unfortunately generalized standard. It’s not something pushed onto kinds (except in some cases) but its what the demographics move towards. Most boys can be presented a barbie and will have no interest and would rather blow stuff up with planes. It’s the same with coding, you can present it to women or other demographics but if they have no interest then that’s that. Just like with kids, though, there are folks who go outside of that and are interested and those folks will seek it out. It never hurts to get the program more accessible and well-known to the student body by tabling or putting information in the newsletters.”